

Architecture of Fleet Street

North Side - from Bolt Court to Temple Bar

No. 149

THE HERITAGE of FLEET STREET

April 2026

(claxity.com) indicates a full description on www.claxity.com Further details and images of Listed buildings can be accessed on www.historicengland.org.uk/sitesearch and entering the address; if accessing many listed buildings, use the map search

No.152-153

Junction with Fetter Lane.

No.173-176.

A Post-modern brick and terracotta composition loosely referencing Jacobean revival Victorian forms. The brick panels are prefabricated, and the return along Fetter Lane is longer than the Fleet Street portion. Somewhat busy, despite the lack of detailed ornament, but with effective relief of mass, relative to its considerable size. Built in 1986 by RF White & Associates.

No.180

Less successful than No. 173-176 across the road, the smooth red brick terminates in blank, extended gables and dull charcoal elevations. Built in 1984 by Thomas Saunders Partners.

No.184

Red brick with stone accents (including superimposed oriel windows), relieving arch and shaped gable. Built in 1892 by Farebrother, Ellis & Clarke.

DC Thomson (No.185) and newspaper offices (No.186)

Like No.184, the façade at No.185 features a relieving arch and oriel windows, here deployed with extra detailing by Meakin, Archer & Stoneham (1913). Meanwhile, No.186 (built 1893), despite the modernised ground floor and merger with No.185, retains period glazed tiling and mosaic spelling out the titles (owned by DC Thomson) of newspapers that had their London base here.

St Dunstan in the West.

The tall Neo-Gothic steeple surmounts the entrance and dominates the street aspect. Also notable, however, are the aedicule with clock and recessed side entrance with a statue of Elizabeth I. Built from 1830 to designs by John Shaw Sr and John Shaw Jr., the interior is octagonal, recalling early Christian styles and wears its Gothicism lightly. Grade I listed.

Law Life Assurance (No.187)

Historicist London stock brick with stone dressing and prominent, rounded oriels and terminating balustrade. Interesting extra storey in the leftward three bays as well as aediculated entrance. Built in 1834 by J. Shaw Jr. Grade II listed.

Coutts & Co. (No.188-190)

Orderly, spare modernism with large roundels around the entrance. Built in 1967 by Anderson, Foster, Wilcox.

No.191-192

Unadventurous 1986 Post-modern recladding of an earlier C20 structure, built by YRM Partners.

Attenborough & Son (No.193)

A former Jeweller and Silversmith was housed in this rounded-corner building of bright red sandstone and profuse ornament. A romantic, eclectic composition of 1883 by Archer & Green. Grade II listed. (claxity.com)

Law Courts Branch of the Bank of England (No.194)

Renaissance Revival, palazzo-style, richly detailed front with loggia turrets at each corner. The former banking hall is now a resplendent pub. A A.W. Blomfield's work (1888) is self-confident and demonstrative. Grade II listed. (claxity.com)

The Royal Courts of Justice (a.k.a The Law Courts)

Spanning the eastern end of the Strand and the beginning of Fleet Street, this 1868 design by George Edmund Street is a high point in Gothic Revival style and in Street's career. It is rich in decorative elements, steeples, ogive arches and allegorical and memorialist sculpture. It was built between 1873 and 1882. Thanks to its institutional role, it retains excellently preserved interiors. Grade I listed.